WANTIAN HUANG

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

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EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, expected May 2027
M.A.	Economics, Columbia University, 2020
B.S.	Economics and Mathematics, University of California San Diego, 2018

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Industrial Organization
Secondary: Applied Econometrics

DISSERTATION

Essays in Empirical Industrial Organization
Committee: Prof. Chenyu Yang (Chair), Prof. Andrew Sweeting, Prof. Ying Fan (University of Michigan)

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Testing the Substitution Predictions of Demand Models: Evidence from the Blue Bell Recall"

Demand models are widely used in empirical industrial organization, yet evidence on their ability to predict real-world counterfactuals remains limited. I use the 2015 Blue Bell ice cream recall, which removed a major regional brand from grocery shelves for several months, to test how model structure and identifying information shape substitution predictions. I compare the predictions of nested logit, random-coefficients logit, and random-coefficients nested logit models with observed changes in rival sales. Random coefficients do not make nest structure less important: the nest structure and the strength of within-nest correlation both change predictions substantially, and models combining nests with random coefficients give some of the most accurate predictions. Holding the model fixed, household category-purchase moments improve predictions in markets where Blue Bell was large, with or without nesting instruments, and using both gives the lowest prediction loss. The results favor comparing economically motivated nest structures even in random-coefficients models and estimating them with household purchase information.

OTHER RESEARCH

"Economies of Scope in Retail Distribution: A Study of Ready-to-Consume Categories," working paper, with Ying Fan, Yidan Xu, and Chenyu Yang

"Evaluating the Welfare Impacts of EV Charging Station Subsidies: An Analysis of the NEVI Program in Texas," working paper

"Quality Uncertainty, Learning, and Product Variety in Live Streaming Platforms," in progress

RESEARCH AND OTHER RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Economist Intern, Amazon Ads Marketing Finance, Seattle, WA, Summer 2026
Research Assistant, Prof. Chenyu Yang, University of Maryland, Summer 2024 and Summer 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Maryland
- Instructor (Undergraduate)
  - Economics of Regulation and Antitrust, Summer 2024
- Teaching Assistant (M.S. in Applied Economics)
  - Information, Game Theory and Market Design, Springs 2022, 2024, and 2025; Fall 2026
  - Microeconomic Analysis, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2026
  - Financial Economics, Spring 2023, Fall 2024, Springs 2025 and 2026
  - Program Analysis and Evaluation, Winters 2022 and 2024–2026
  - Topics in Applied Macroeconomics, Fall 2021, Winter 2026
  - Empirical Analysis III: Econometric Modeling and Forecasting, Fall 2025
  - Environmental Economics, Winters 2022–2025
  - Economic Analysis of Law, Spring 2022, Falls 2023 and 2024
  - International Macroeconomics and Finance, Falls 2022 and 2024
  - Economic Development, Spring 2023
  - International Trade and Applications, Winter 2022

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent)

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, EconML), SQL (Redshift, Hive, Spark), Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX; HPC (SLURM)

REFERENCES

Prof. Chenyu Yang	University of Maryland	cyang111@umd.edu	(301) 405-3512
Prof. Andrew Sweeting	University of Maryland	atsweet@umd.edu	(301) 405-8325
Prof. Ying Fan	University of Michigan	yingfan@umich.edu	(734) 763-3096